

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 583

By Roberts

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Humphreys County Sheriff Chris Davis upon being named 2025 Tennessean of the Year by *The Tennessean*.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to the safety and wellbeing of their fellow citizens and who, in times of crisis, exemplify courage, compassion, and steady leadership; and

WHEREAS, Humphreys County Sheriff Chris Davis is one such outstanding Tennessean, having been named the 2025 Tennessean of the Year by the editorial board of *The Tennessean* in recognition of his empathy, grace, and leadership in the face of profound tragedy; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Davis is a proud son of Waverly and a graduate of Waverly Central High School, where he was a standout on the football team; he pursued higher education at Murray State University, studying public safety and health and playing on the 1986 Ohio Valley Conference Championship football team under legendary coach Frank Beamer, and at Middle Tennessee State University, where he studied criminal justice and law enforcement administration; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Chris Davis began his law enforcement career in 1986 as a dispatcher and jailer with the Humphreys County Sheriff's Office under Sheriff Ronnie Toungette; and

WHEREAS, in 1989, he joined the Dickson County Sheriff's Office, and in 1990, he became a patrolman for the City of Dickson Police Department, where he taught the D.A.R.E. curriculum in Dickson and Humphreys County schools, earned the rank of corporal, and served on the Special Response Team; and

WHEREAS, in 1993, he joined the 23rd Judicial District Drug Task Force in the Criminal Investigation Unit and was promoted to chief agent in 1995; three years later, he continued his service to the State as an officer with the Tennessee Alcoholic Beverage Commission; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Davis returned to the Dickson County Sheriff's Office in 1999 under Sheriff Tom Wall, where he was assigned to the vice narcotics unit and became a member of the hostage negotiation team; and

WHEREAS, in 2006, at the age of thirty-seven, Chris Davis was elected Sheriff of Humphreys County, a position in which he has served with distinction ever since; and

WHEREAS, throughout his thirty-plus years in law enforcement, Sheriff Davis has been present at many of his county's most difficult moments; in August 2021, when unprecedented floods devastated Waverly and surrounding areas, destroying homes and businesses and claiming twenty lives, he led with resolve and compassion, bearing witness to heartbreaking loss while helping guide his community through response, recovery, and grief; and

WHEREAS, on October 10, 2025, when an explosion at the Accurate Energetic Systems munitions facility on the Humphreys–Hickman County line claimed sixteen lives, Sheriff Davis again rushed to the scene, coordinating with first responders, plant officials, and neighboring agencies, even as he learned that longtime friends and neighbors were among the missing; and

WHEREAS, in the days that followed, Sheriff Chris Davis worked closely with Hickman County Sheriff Jason Craft and other officials, helped direct ongoing emergency operations, and undertook the duty of delivering death notifications to families; during press briefings and community vigils, his visible emotion and honest acknowledgment of shared pain became a source of strength and connection for a grieving community; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Davis has been quoted locally, nationally, and internationally for his remarks in the wake of these tragedies, and he has used his platform to speak candidly about the emotional toll such events take on first responders and survivors; he has encouraged his

deputies and colleagues to seek counseling and debriefings and has helped to lessen the stigma surrounding mental health care, particularly for men in rural communities; and

WHEREAS, beyond his official duties, Sheriff Davis has organized and supported numerous fish fry fundraisers for residents battling life-threatening illnesses, helped restore utilities for families whose power had been cut off, and, for some thirty years, has played Santa Claus and helped organize Angel Tree efforts so that children in need receive gifts at Christmas; and

WHEREAS, a devoted family man, Sheriff Chris Davis is the son of Dickie Davis and Tonia Wiles and the grandson of Daniel D. and Lois Long Davis and Clint "Jack" and Vivian Woods; he and his wife, Daphne Peek Davis, are the proud parents of three adult children, David, Daniel, and Eran, who carries on the family legacy of service as an employee of the Humphreys County Sheriff's Office; and

WHEREAS, in naming Sheriff Davis its 2025 Tennessean of the Year, *The Tennessean* editorial board recognized his long record of public service, his steady leadership during the 2021 flood and the 2025 plant explosion, and his ongoing service to the people of Humphreys County; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Chris Davis epitomizes the spirit of compassion and courage that are characteristic of a true Tennessean, and it is wholly appropriate that we honor him for his exemplary record of service to the people of Humphreys County and this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Humphreys County Sheriff Chris Davis upon being named the 2025 Tennessean of the Year by *The Tennessean* and extend to him our deepest gratitude for his decades of faithful service to the people of Humphreys County and the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.